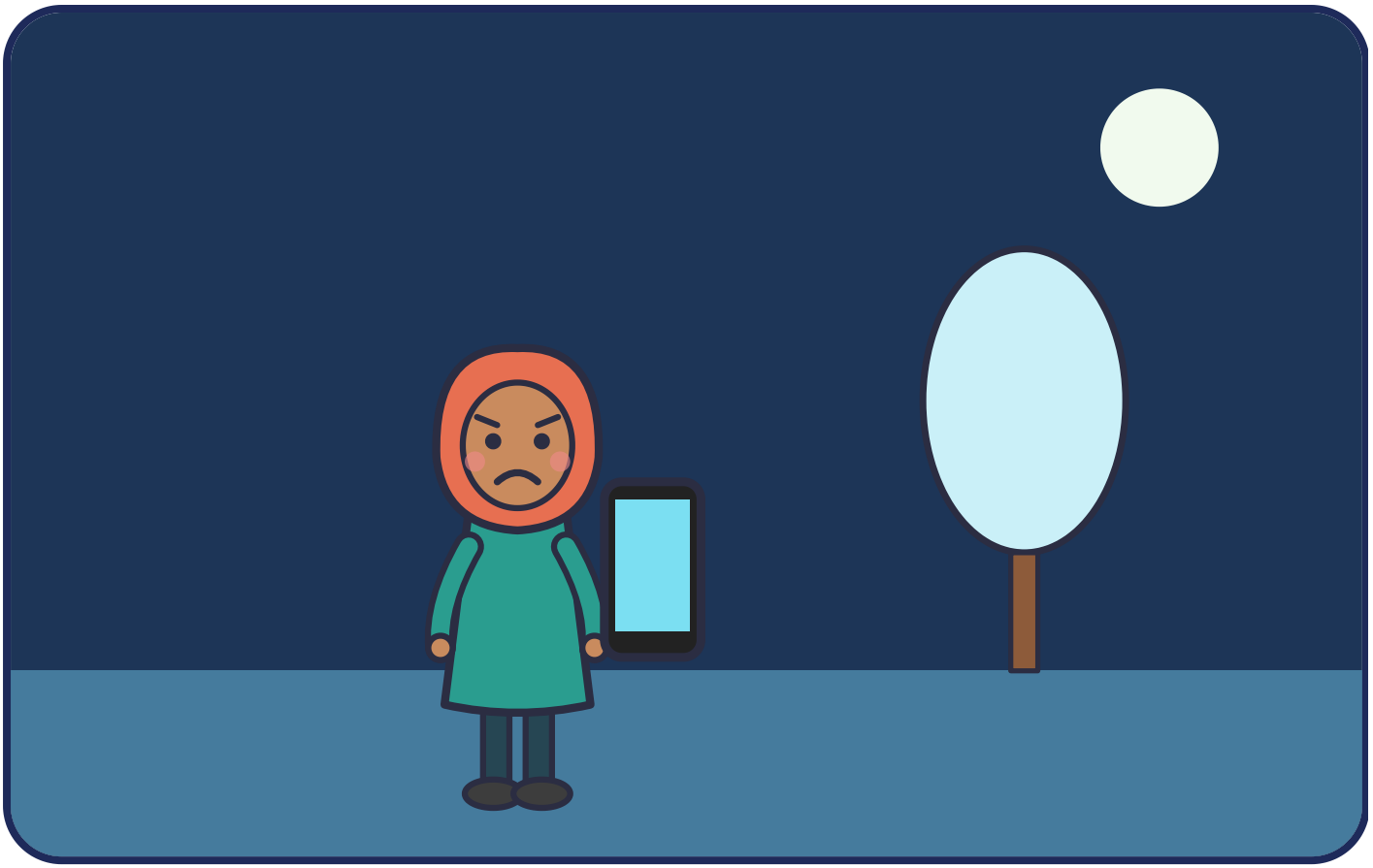


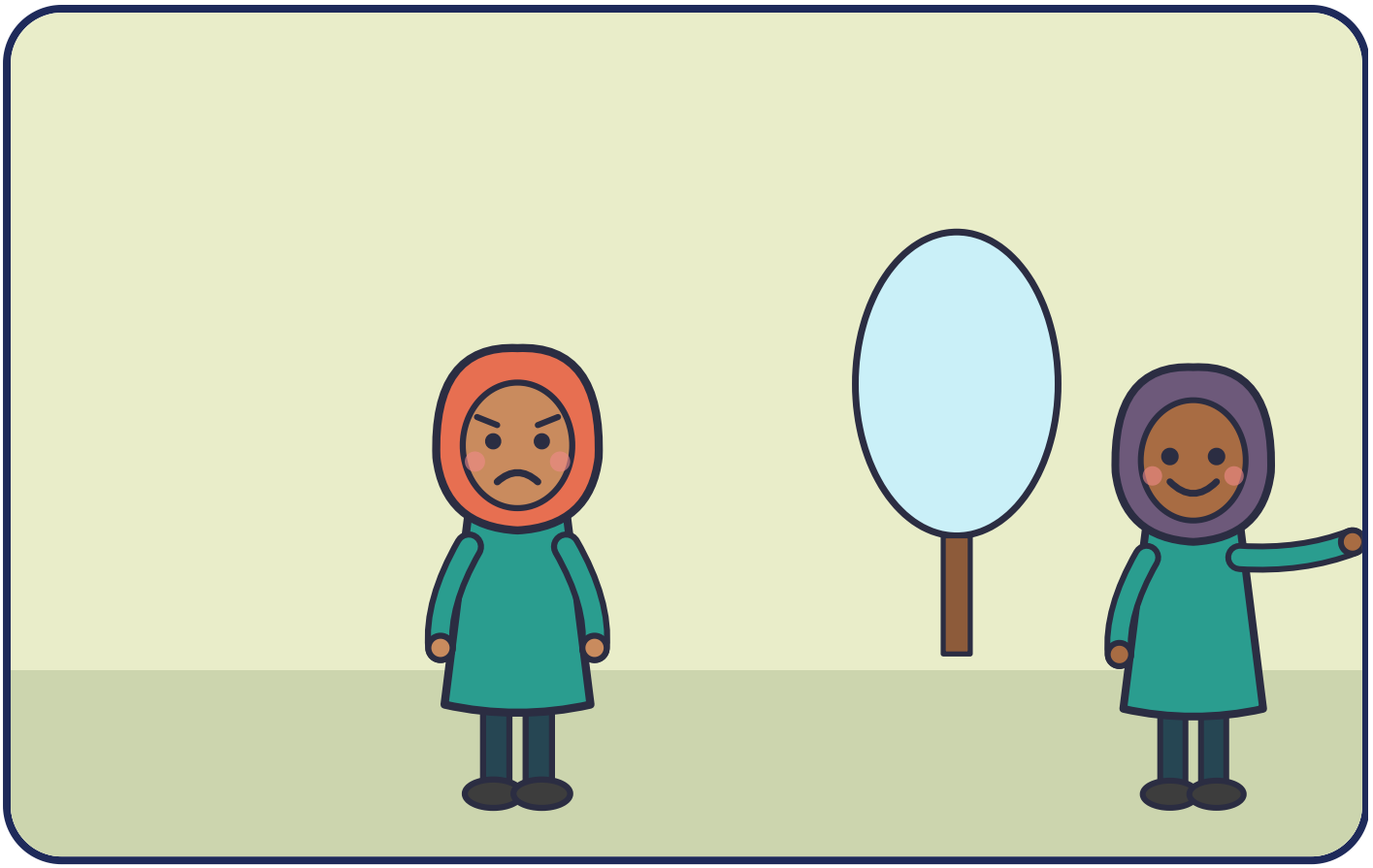
Nour's Screen-Free Challenge

English Mood Academy

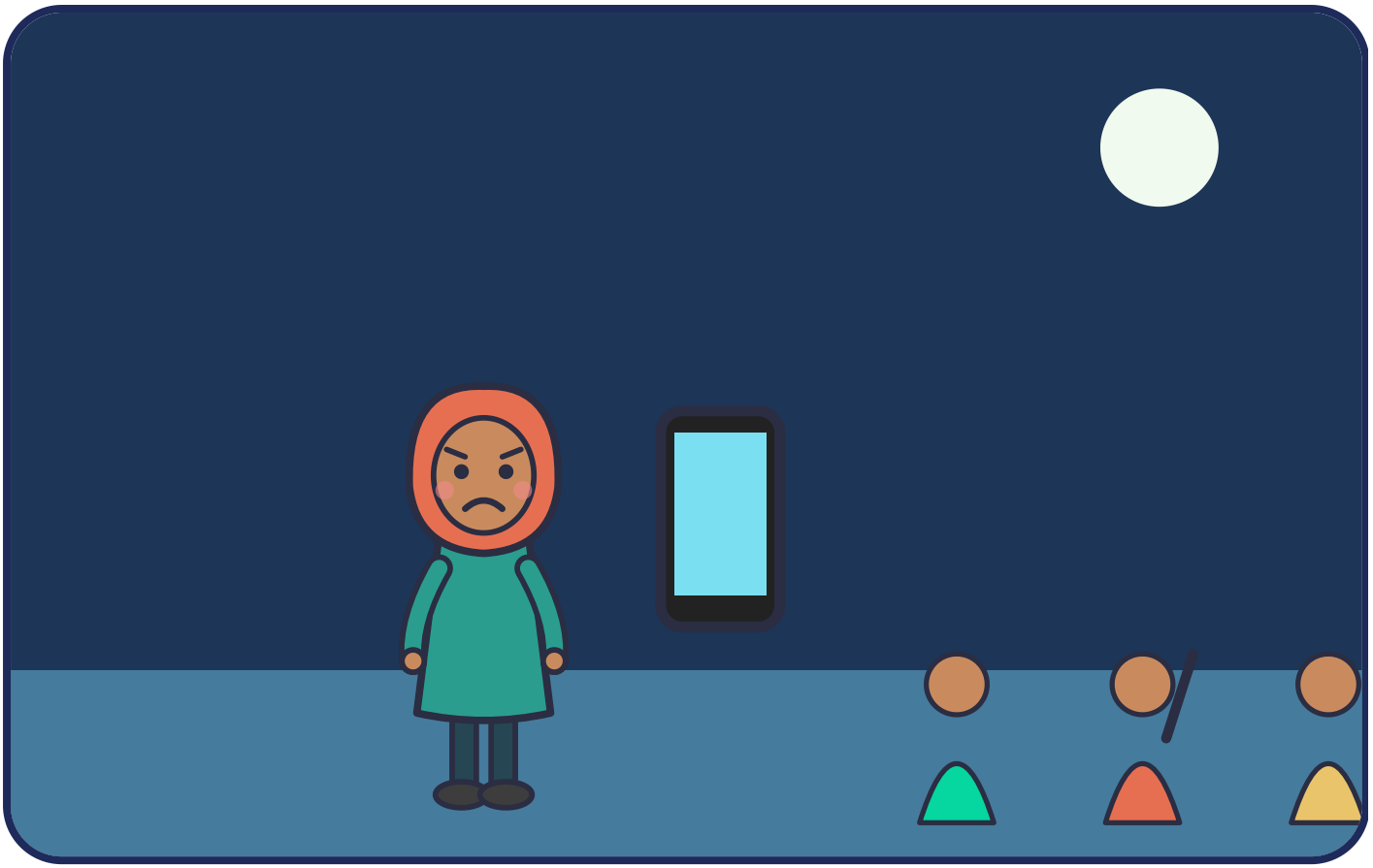
yellow = new words **red** = gerund / infinitive



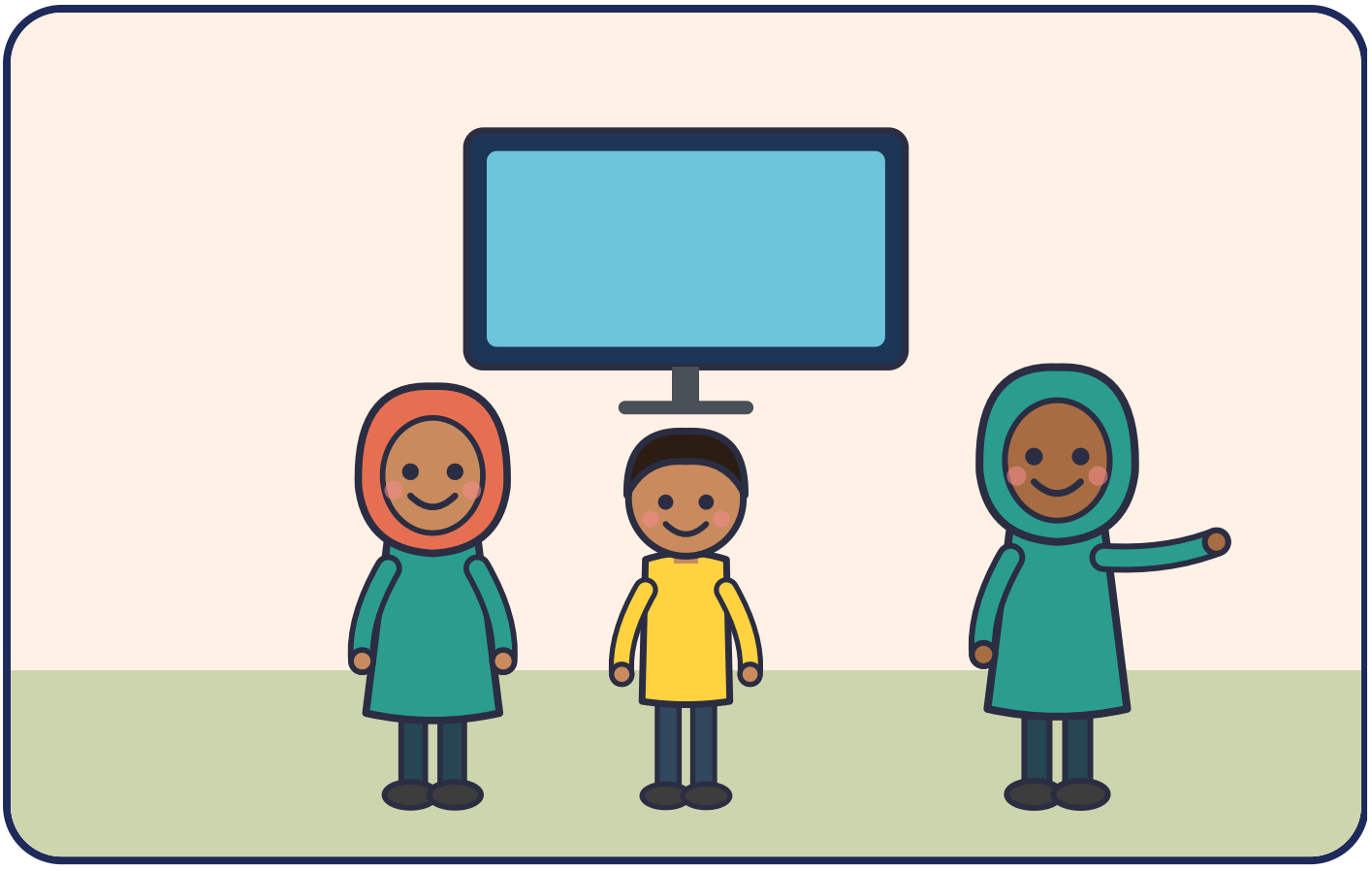
Nour, who is sixteen, spent hours on social media every night. Comparing herself to filtered photos hurt her **self-esteem**, and she tried to **avoid looking** in the mirror.



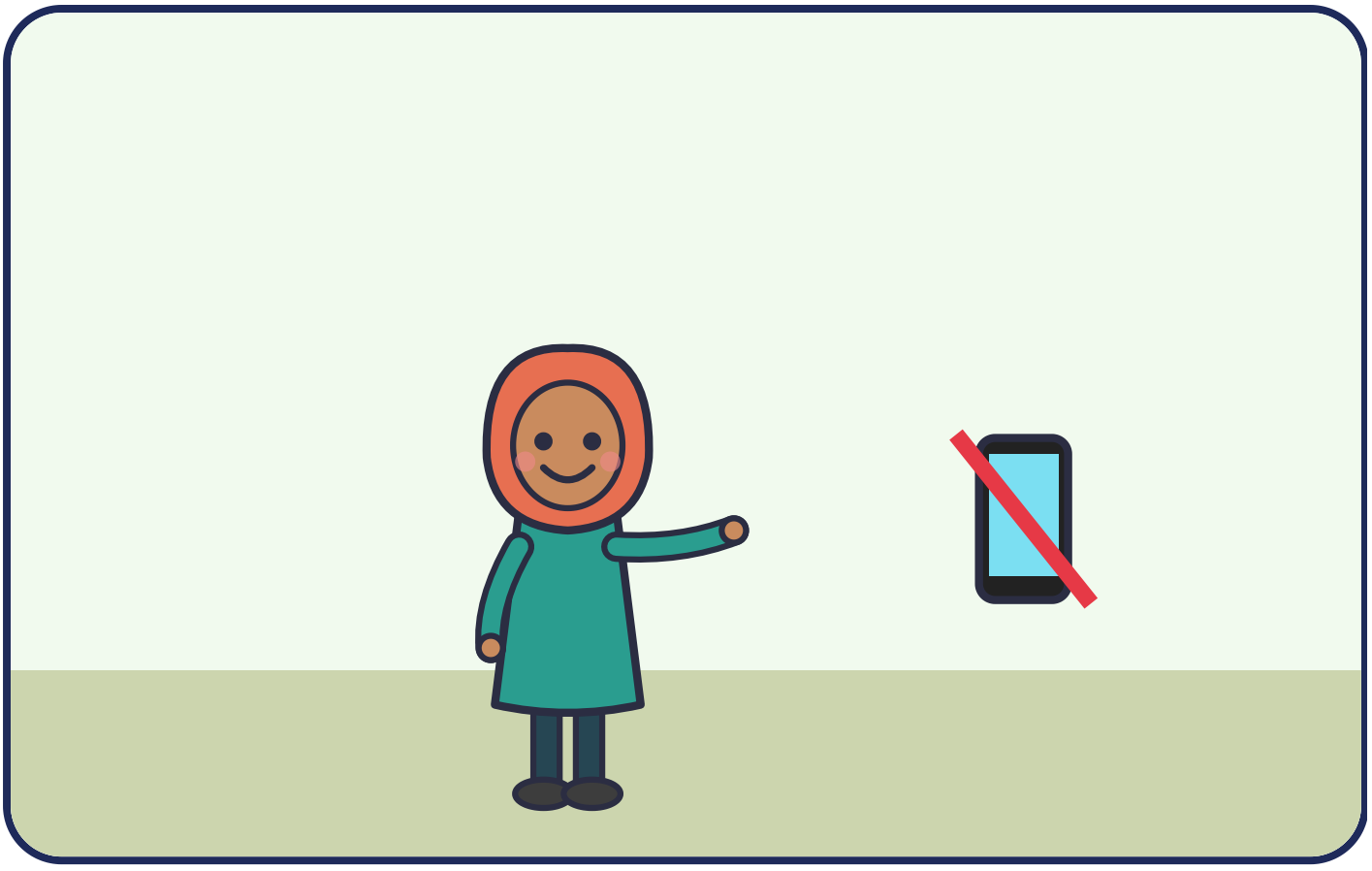
Her **self-image** was shaped by a **biased** world of perfect pictures. "Isn't real life more important?" her mother asked — a **rhetorical question**.



Late-night scrolling began to **interfere** with her sleep. The apps were **addictive**, and Nour started to **withdraw** from her friends.



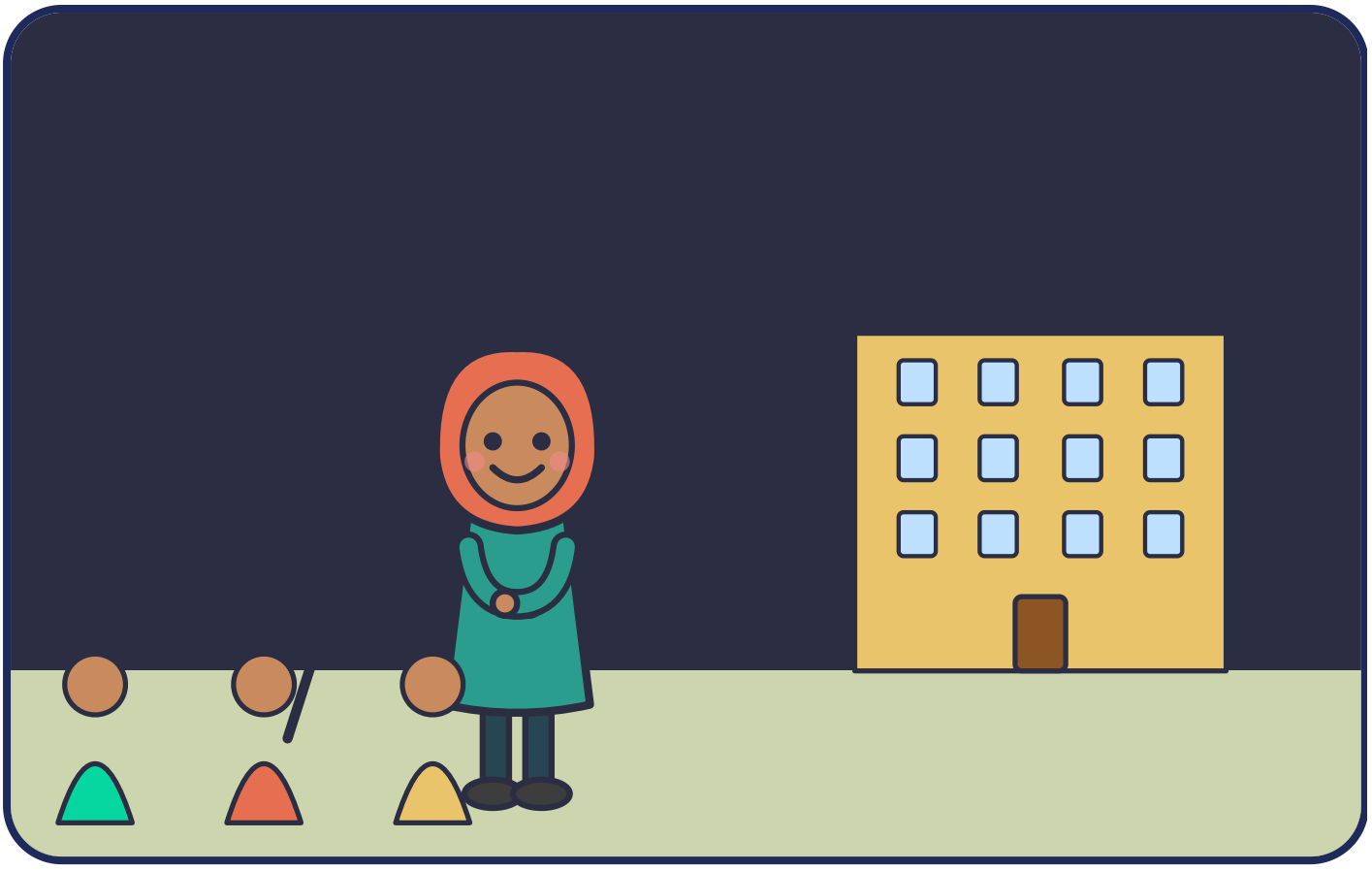
One day, a school **nutritionist** spoke about **well-being**. "A **sedentary** life and **processed food** harm your body and mind," she said.



So Nour **decided to try** a screen-free week. She set a clear **boundary**: no phone after nine o'clock. It was a small **nudge**, but it gave her **agency**.



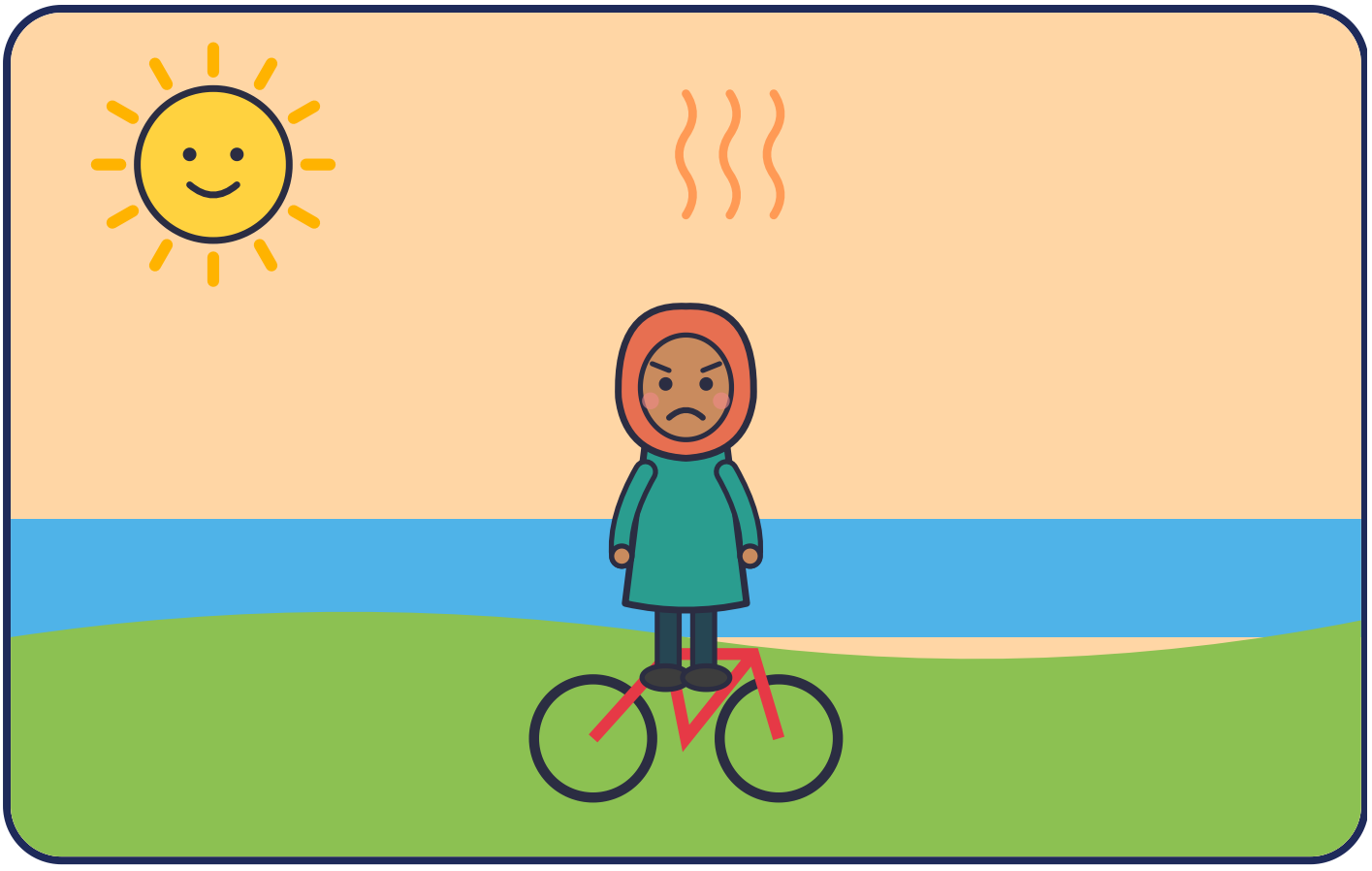
Feeling bored, she joined the school art club. She **enjoyed drawing**, and the **cognitive** benefits were real. Her **engagement** in class grew every day.



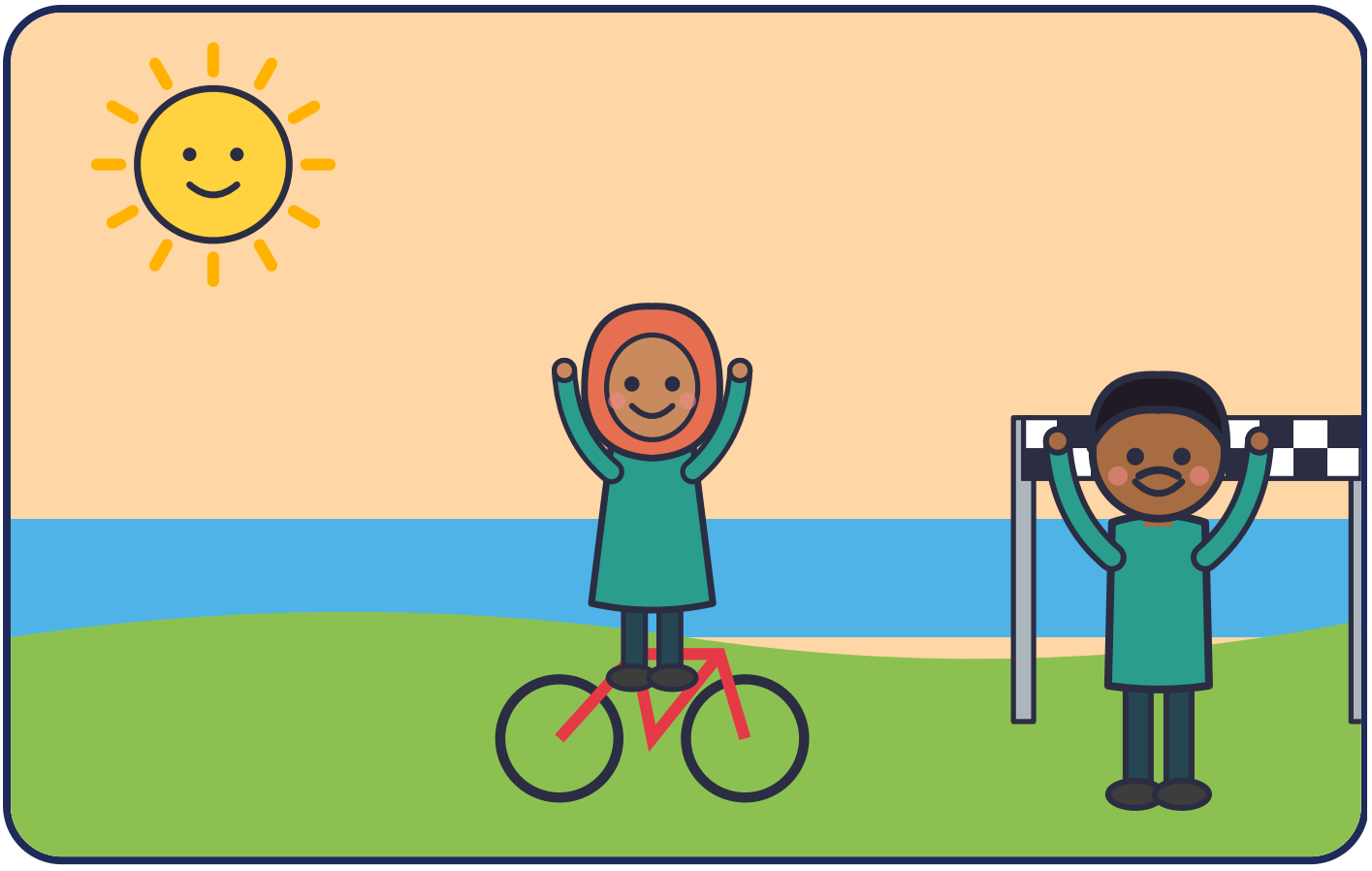
At the play **rehearsal**, the lights broke. Nour showed **flexibility** and painted an **authentic** Cairo street as the background.



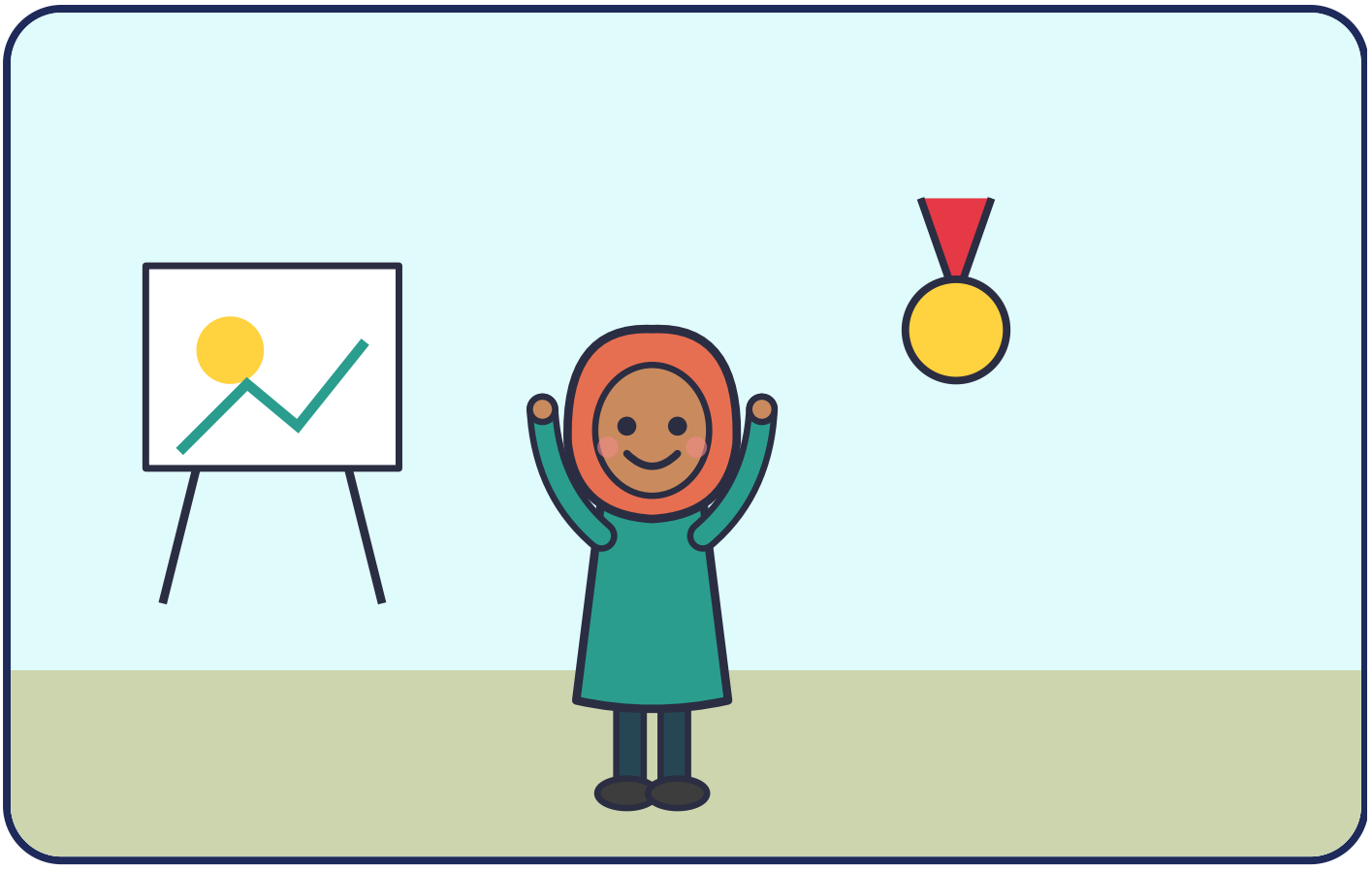
Then her uncle **suggested joining** him on a long bike ride. Nour **didn't mind waking** up at dawn. The Nile seemed to **shimmer** in the sun.



As the day began to **wear on**, she had to **struggle** to keep up. Her legs ached, but she **refused to give up** and **kept pedalling**.



"**Keep going**!" her uncle shouted. When they reached the bridge, Nour felt a huge sense of **achievement** and real **enjoyment**.



Nour learned that **resilience** grows with every challenge. Now she is **mindful** of her screen time and **plans to keep** her life **fulfilling**.

The End 🚴

Real life is more fulfilling than a perfect screen. Set boundaries and keep going!

الحياة الحقيقية أحلى من أي شاشة. حط لنفسك حدود وكمّل!

Words from the story

self-esteem	تقدير الذات
self-image	الصورة الذاتية
biased	متحيز
rhetorical question	سؤال بلاغي
interfere	يتدخل - يعطّل
addictive	يسبب الإدمان
withdraw	ينسحب - ينطوي
nutritionist	أخصائي تغذية
well-being	الصحة والرفاهية
sedentary	قليل الحركة
processed food	طعام مصنّع
boundary	حد
nudge	دفعة خفيفة - تشجيع بسيط
agency	القدرة على التصرف
cognitive	إدراكي - معرفي
engagement	مشاركة - انخراط
rehearsal	بروفة
flexibility	مرونة
authentic	أصيل - حقيقي
shimmer	يتلألأ
wear on	يمر ببطء
struggle	يكافح - يعاني
keep going	يستمر
achievement	إنجاز
enjoyment	استمتاع
resilience	المرونة - القدرة على التعافي
mindful	واعٍ - منتبه
fulfilling	مُرضٍ

Gerunds & Infinitives

avoid + -ing | decide + to * | enjoy + -ing | suggest + -ing | mind + -ing | refuse + to * | keep + -ing | plan + to *